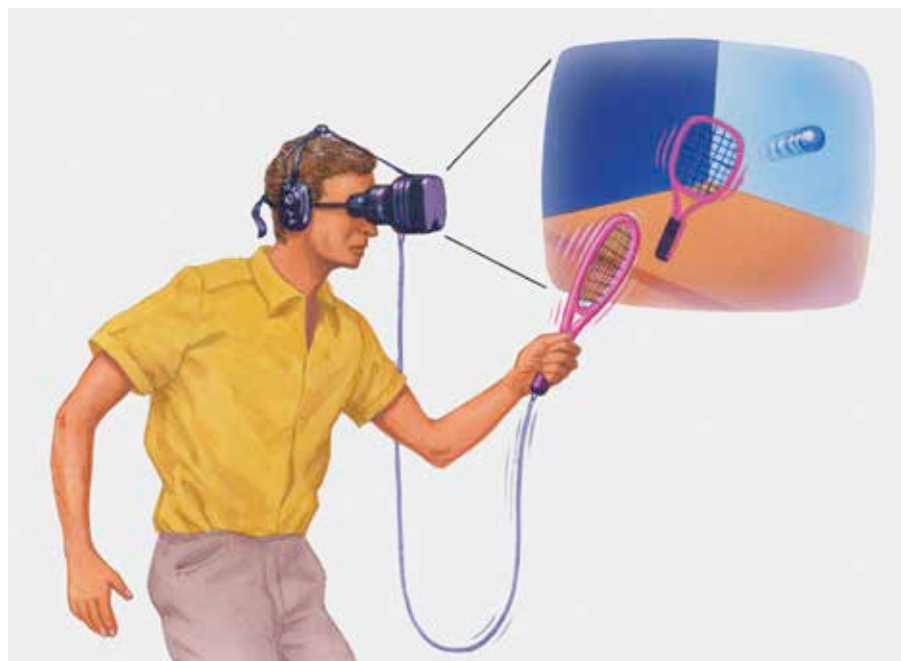


So what is “reality” anyway? What’s “real”? Is the smart phone the world has got its nose buried in real? Is having a ton of Facebook friends who you never meet with, reality? Technology has invaded most of our lives, but not everyone’s life, and thus the very definition of reality is about as clear as the vision of a near-sighted senior citizen without spectacles, stumbling about on a very dark and foggy night.

It’s not like we can break technology users into simple haves and have-nots groups. The haves are made up of the have-a-littles and the have-a-lots, then there are the have-too-muchses and the lives-only-in-cyberspaces... Some people live in a virtual world, eating only takeout and drinking energy drinks to stay awake and get even more time with tech, whilst others only ever interface with technology on an urgent need basis, which could be anything from once a day to almost never.

For the purpose of this magazine, which is certainly read only by the haves, and perhaps we can stretch a little to assume it’s mainly read by the have-too-muchses, we’re simplifying things and assuming “reality” for us includes everyday technology, and enhanced-reality (reality+?), which is what this cover story is about, is using some existing and some



yet-to-be-released-to-the-masses tech that we think will change our lives forever.

Why is this important? As early adopters, Digit readers are usually on the cutting edge (if not owning cutting-edge tech, then definitely reading up and knowing everything there is to know about said tech), and it’s the people on the cutting edge that define what becomes of a technology. You will talk to those less learned than you and influence them. Some of you will jump early on to the bandwagon and

start creating apps, services and more for this reality+ future. Others will be, say, amongst the first Indians to get things such as the Oculus Rift, whenever it’s released, and will set the tone for how it’s perceived by the have-nots, or the not-yets.

Amongst the other stories is exactly that, our personal experience with virtual reality and the Oculus, and our dreams for the future of VR. Our cover is augmented, but that’s just the start of what is possible. With faster 4G networks and things such as videos and advanced augmentations becoming a lot easier to deliver, you can expect such an experience to become mainstream - the norm, instead of the exception. It’s not all fun and games though, as you will learn in the pages that follow, in fact technology layered on top of reality may be the way to save lives, the environment, and help educate our kids better.

Enhanced-Reality is the future, and the shift to it has already begun. The only question is how enhanced will our reality be going forward? Whilst some may wonder how “real” such a reality would be to begin with... reality, in the end, is what you choose to make it. **[i]**

VR IN MOVIES: VANILLA SKY

The concept of cryo-sleep or cold sleep has been breached upon many times and it concerns the preservation of humans at low temperature, with the guarantee of revival at a later date. The concept was also shown in the recent hit movie, “Interstellar”. But what would happen when the field of cryonics develops beyond a certain extent, when people who are in cryosleep experience virtual reality simulations, which are basically programmed dreams, that look real and indistinguishable from reality. We won’t really delve into how this is relevant in Vanilla Sky, suffice to say that we may have already spoilt it slightly for you and if you’re really concerned about spoilers, watch the movie first.

The movie has an interesting take on cryopreservation and lucid dreaming and we must say, it’s been done very well. It talks about dealing with tragedy, the assistance that VR can provide in such a situation and it provides a lucid, relatable backdrop to the future of VR and its potential to pervade every aspect of our lives, now, and in the near future.